

HA-JOON CHUNG

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Research Interests

Education and Stratification, Family Sociology, Causal Mediation Analysis

Academic Employment

- 2026-present Postdoctoral Research Associate, Department of Sociology
Princeton University
- 2019-present Research Assistant, Committee on Quantitative Research Methods
University of Chicago

Education

- 2026 Princeton University – Princeton, NJ
Ph.D., Sociology and Social Policy
Committee: James M. Raymo (chair), Guanglei Hong, Brandon Stewart, Florencia Torche, Yu Xie
- 2019 University of Chicago – Chicago, IL
M.A., Social Sciences (Concentration: Quantitative Methods & Social Analysis)
Advisor: Stephen W. Raudenbush
- 2018 Yonsei University – Seoul, South Korea
B.A., Sociology

Additional Training

- 2026 Certificate in Demography, Office of Population Research, Princeton University
- 2026 Certificate in Statistics and Machine Learning, Center for Statistics and Machine Learning,
Princeton University
- 2024 10th Annual Berkeley Workshop on Formal Demography, University of California, Berkeley
- 2018 Korean National Teacher's License (Secondary, Social Studies), Yonsei University

Publications

Chung, H-J., & Hong, G. 2025. ["Real-World Implications of a Methodological Dilemma: Endogenous Confounding in Causal Decomposition Analysis."](#)

In *Causal Inference*, edited by Xiao-Hua Zhou and Jinzhu Jia, 49–64. Singapore: Springer Nature.

Hong, G., & **Chung, H.-J.** 2024. ["Assessing the Impact of the Great Recession on the Transition to Adulthood."](#) *Sociological Methods & Research* 53 (3): 1453–90.

Selected Work in Progress

Chung, H-J., & Raymo, J. "Concerted Cultivation and Children's Academic Performance: The Role of School Belongingness." *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility* (Conditional Accept)

Chung, H-J., & Jang, M. "The Skill Profile of College Majors: A Multidimensional Approach to Occupational Mismatch and Wages." *American Journal of Sociology* (Revise & Resubmitted)

Chung, H-J., & Hong, G. "Scope and Scale of Educational Interventions: Sociological Implications of Causal Decomposition Analysis."

Chung, H-J. "Educational Gradient at the Top: Variations in Fertility Timing of Young Adults by College Prestige."

Chung, H-J. "Changing Value of Educational Credential in the Marriage Market."

Chung, H-J. "Not Why I Went to College: Examining Motherhood Penalty in Major-Occupation Mismatch."

Raymo, J., Park, H., & **Chung, H-J.** "Children's Educational Attainment as a Component of Family Success: Vignette Experiments in 8 Countries."

Grants and Research Funding

- 2023-2025 Graduate Funding for Research, Princeton Institute for International and Regional Studies (PIIRS)
Independently designed and carried out an international research project on class and childrearing in South Korea; managed the project budget and secured IRB approval for data collection.
- 2023 William T. Grant Foundation, Research Grant Application
"Would Reducing Inequality in STEM Learning Mitigate the Differential Impacts of a Global Crisis?" Co-developed with Guanglei Hong (PI). Letter of Inquiry selected to advance to the full-proposal stage; Not funded.

Awards, Honors, and Fellowships

- 2024-25 Prize Fellowship in the Social Sciences, Princeton University
A competitive, interdisciplinary fellowship for policy-relevant social science.
- 2019 Princeton Fellowship in the Humanities and Social Sciences, Princeton University

Teaching

- Fall 2026 Assistant Instructor: **Applied Social Statistics (Graduate-level)**
Instructor: Brandon M. Stewart, Department of Sociology, Princeton University
- Fall 2022, Fall 2021 Assistant Instructor: **Statistical Methods in Sociology**
Instructor: Tod G. Hamilton, Department of Sociology, Princeton University
- Spring 2023 Assistant Instructor: **Sociological Theory**
Instructor: John N. Robinson III, Department of Sociology, Princeton University
- Spring 2022 Assistant Instructor: **Machine Learning with Social Data: Opportunities and Challenges**
Instructor: Brandon M. Stewart, Department of Sociology, Princeton University

K-12 Teaching (South Korea)

- 2018 Student Teacher, Shin-il Middle School, Seoul (Subject: Social Studies)
- 2012, 2015-16 Volunteer Teacher, after-school programs at Hwagea Elementary and Shin-il/Banghak Middle Schools, Seoul

Professional Presentations

American Sociological Association (ASA) Annual Meeting

- 2025 — Presenter. "Occupational Potential of College Majors: Measurement and Application"
"Household Pets in Lowest-low Fertility Contexts: The Case of South Korea and Japan"
- 2024 — Roundtable. "School-to-Work Transition: The Story of Path Dependency and Agency."
- 2023 — Roundtable. "A New Solution to Endogenous Confounding in Racial Disparity Decomposition."
- 2022 — Roundtable. "Revisiting Cultural Capital in the School Context."

Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting

- 2026 — Presenter. "Not Why I Went to College: Examining Motherhood Penalty and Major-Occupation Mismatch"
Poster. "Race-Blind or Race-Conscious: Substantive Implications of a Methodological Dilemma"
- 2025 — Poster. "Education Gradient at the Top: 4-Year College Prestige and Fertility Behavior."
- 2024 — Presenter. "Investment in Children and Children's Educational Attainment as Components of Family Success: Vignette Experiments in 8 Countries"
Poster. "Mismatch at the Bottom: Education-Income Exchange in Marriages."

2023 — Poster. "The Heterogeneous Great Recession Effect on Child Development."

2022 — Presenter. "Parenting in a 'Class-Homogenized Cultivation' Society: Class and Childrearing in South Korea."

Research Committee 28 on Social Stratification and Mobility (RC28) Annual Conference

2026 — Presenter. "Not Why I Went to College: Examining Motherhood Penalty and Major-Occupation Mismatch"

2025 (Milan) — Presenter. "School Adjustment as the Mechanism of Classed Parenting Effect on Achievement: The Case of South Korea."

2024 — Presenter. "Reducing the Racial Gap in the Horizontally Stratified Colleges: Implications for Single Pregnancy During Emerging Adulthood."

Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE) Summer Conference

2024 — Presenter. "An Equity-Oriented Approach to Causal Decomposition Analysis."

Research on East Asian Demography and Inequality (READI) Summer Conference

2023 — Presenter. "What They Want, What They Do: Classed Parenting in a 'Universal Concerted Cultivation' Society."

International Conference on Sociology of Korea (I-CSK)

2024 — Presenter. "Is It All Puppies and Rainbows?: Household Pets in the Lowest-Low Fertility Context."

Community Organization and Other Services

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| 2024-present | Co-organizer, Research on East Asian Demography and Inequality (READI) Early Career Workshop
<i>Organize a monthly research workshop for graduate students and early-career scholars studying East Asia; organize a professionalization event at the PAA annual meeting</i> |
| 2023-2024 | Representative, Graduate Student Action Committee, Office of Population Research, Princeton University
<i>Organized professionalization sessions, student research and writing workshops, and departmental social events</i> |
| 2022-2023 | Co-organizer, Family Demography Working Group, Princeton University
<i>Co-organized workshops with James Raymo and Alicia Adserà; facilitated student presentations of works-in-progress</i> |
| 2022-2026 | Residential Graduate Student, Yeh College, Princeton University
<i>Advise 30–40 first-year undergraduates annually on coursework and university life; support graduating seniors with thesis writing; organize social and professionalization events</i> |

Programming, Software, and Language Skills

Programming languages: R, Stata, Python (natural language processing)

Languages: Korean (native), Japanese (intermediate)